

Content Brief Template Guide

Purpose

This document serves as the strategic source of truth before content creation begins.

The objective is to transform a content request into a structured brief that aligns content with business goals, buyer journey stages, audience needs, messaging frameworks, and product positioning.

The AI should complete every section using available inputs, supporting documentation, and organizational knowledge sources.

1. Content Overview

Content Title

[Working title generated from request]

Content Type

[Blog Article / Webinar Recap / eBook / Case Study / Landing Page / Solution Brief / Report / Guide]

Requester

[Name]

Requester Email

[Email]

Request Date

[Date]

Content Priority

[High / Medium / Low]

2. Request Summary

Objective

Provide a concise summary of:

- What is being requested
- Why it is being created
- What business goal it supports

Template

This content is being created to:

[Describe purpose]

The primary business outcome is:

[Demand Generation / Pipeline Acceleration / Brand Awareness / Customer Education / Product Adoption / Retention]

The target audience should leave with:

[Desired takeaway]

3. Strategic Classification

Theme

Select the most relevant content pillar.

Theme

[Theme Name]

Reasoning

Explain why this theme is the strongest match.

Consider:

- Core problem being addressed
 - Business objective
 - Audience intent
 - Messaging framework alignment
-

Product Alignment

Primary Product

[Product Name]

Secondary Products

[List if applicable]

Reasoning

Explain why these products are relevant to the request.

4. Audience Definition

Primary Persona

[Persona]

Persona Goals

- [Goal]
- [Goal]
- [Goal]

Pain Points

- [Pain Point]
 - [Pain Point]
 - [Pain Point]
-

Secondary Personas

[List if applicable]

5. Buyer Journey Mapping

Stage

[Awareness / Discovery / Consideration / Decision / Retention / Advocacy]

Audience Question

Identify the core question the audience is trying to answer at this stage.

Template

At this stage, the audience is asking:

"[Buyer Question]"

Why This Stage Fits

Explain why this request aligns with this stage rather than another stage.

Reference:

- Audience intent
- Level of product understanding
- Desired outcome

6. Content Objective

Primary Objective

Select one:

- Educate
 - Build Trust
 - Generate Demand
 - Capture Leads
 - Accelerate Pipeline
 - Drive Product Adoption
 - Retain Customers
 - Establish Thought Leadership
-

Secondary Objectives

[List additional objectives]

Success Criteria

Content should achieve:

- [Outcome]
 - [Outcome]
 - [Outcome]
-

7. Recommended Angle

Narrative Approach

Describe the recommended framing.

Template

Position the content as:

[Recommended framing]

The content should focus on:

- [Focus Area]
- [Focus Area]
- [Focus Area]

Avoid focusing on:

- [Misaligned Angle]
 - [Misaligned Angle]
-

8. Key Messages

Identify the 3–5 messages readers should remember after consuming the content.

Message 1

[Core Message]

Supporting Points

- [Evidence]
 - [Evidence]
-

Message 2

[Core Message]

Supporting Points

- [Evidence]
- [Evidence]

Message 3

[Core Message]

Supporting Points

- [Evidence]
 - [Evidence]
-

9. Evidence Requirements

List supporting assets needed before drafting.

Required Sources

Internal Sources

- [Documentation]
- [Research]
- [Product Material]
- [Customer Insights]

External Sources

- [Industry Reports]
 - [Research Studies]
 - [Analyst Reports]
-

Subject Matter Experts

Required Stakeholders

- [SME Name / Team]
- [SME Name / Team]

Expected Contribution

- [Validation]
 - [Quote]
 - [Data Point]
-

10. Content Structure Recommendation

Suggested Sections

Introduction

Purpose:

[Purpose]

Section 1

Topic:

[Topic]

Objective:

[Objective]

Section 2

Topic:

[Topic]

Objective:

[Objective]

Section 3

Topic:

[Topic]

Objective:

[Objective]

Conclusion

Purpose:

[Purpose]

11. Calls To Action

Primary CTA

[CTA]

Desired Action

[Action]

Secondary CTA

[CTA]

Desired Action

[Action]

12. Risks And Gaps

Identify missing information before drafting.

Missing Inputs

- [Gap]
 - [Gap]
 - [Gap]
-

Assumptions Being Made

- [Assumption]
 - [Assumption]
-

Validation Required

Before drafting, confirm:

- [Validation Item]
 - [Validation Item]
 - [Validation Item]
-

13. AI Drafting Instructions

When generating content:

Prioritize

- Audience relevance
- Strategic messaging
- Evidence-backed claims
- Clear buyer progression

Maintain

- Approved brand voice
- Theme alignment
- Persona alignment
- Buyer-stage alignment

Avoid

- Unsupported claims
- Generic marketing language
- Repetition
- Product-first messaging without context

Success Test

A reader should finish the content and be able to answer:

"[Primary Buyer Question]"